

Master of Science in Medical Sciences

Academic Integrity and Professionalism

MEDSCIEN 9505

Course Outline for Summer 2026

This course takes place at Western University, which is located on the traditional territories of the Anishinaabek, Haudenosaunee, Lūnaapéewak, and Chonnonton Nations, on lands connected with the London Township and Sombra Treaties of 1796 and the Dish with One Spoon Covenant Wampum.

Students who are in emotional and/or mental distress should refer to <https://www.uwo.ca/health/> for a complete list of options about how to obtain help.

1. Course Description and Design

This course will look at ethics and professionalism across the biomedical ecosystem including research, clinical work, and industry. We will openly discuss what constitutes ethical and professional behaviour, and the implications of lapses in that conduct. Students will explore the importance of working in an ethical manner and how to establish an environment that supports professional behaviour. Elements that drive professional behaviour, and effective teamwork will be discussed. Much of the learning will be case based, with specific scenarios discussed in small groups or as a class. Many cases are not black and white, and students are encouraged to examine scenarios from multiple viewpoints. The goal of the course will be to identify ethical issues early and develop mechanisms that ensure exemplary behaviour in biomedical careers.

Delivery Mode: In-person; sessions are not recorded

2. Learning Objectives

- Apply academic integrity principles within your course discussions and throughout your program rotations
- Develop a thorough understanding of professionalism in multiple professional settings
- Evaluate red flags and learn how to prevent academic and professional misconduct

3. Contact Information

Instructor(s)	Contact Information
Dr. Thomas Drysdale Professor	tadrysda@uwo.ca
Dr. Timothy Wilson, Professor	tim.wilson@uwo.ca

Note: Please contact Dr. Thomas Drysdale via email for all course inquiries.

4. Course Content and Schedule

Week	Date	Topic/Activities
1	Monday June 29	Academic Integrity
1	Tuesday June 30	Lab Professionalism
2	Monday July 6	Professional Values
2	Wednesday July 8	Effective Teamwork
3	Monday July 13	Clinical Professional Conduct
3	Wednesday July 15	Professionalism Case Studies
4	Monday July 20	AI Ethics
4	Wednesday July 22	Student Presentations

Note: All sessions will run 9:30 AM to 12:30 pm in Natural Sciences Room 245.

5. Course Evaluations

This is a 0.5 credit course and will be assigned a letter grade (e.g., A, B, or F) based on evaluation of course tasks (~75%) and preparedness, participation, and professionalism (~25%).

Task	Format	Due Date
Obokata Case Brief	Written; individual	Pt. 1 (June 29 9AM) Pt. 2(July 3
Retraction Story Assignment	Written; individual	July 10 12PM
AI Misconduct and Prevention	Written; individual	July 17 12PM
Ethical Dilemmas	Written; individual	July 24 12PM
Final Presentations	Oral; group	July 22 12PM
Progress Report	Written; individual	July 28 12PM

6. Policies

A. Enrollment Restrictions

Enrollment in this course is restricted to graduate students in the Master of Science in Medical Sciences Program.

B. Statement on Academic Offences

Scholastic offences are taken seriously, and students are directed to read the appropriate policy, specifically, the definition of what constitutes a Scholastic Offence, at the following website: https://www.uwo.ca/univsec/pdf/academic_policies/appeals/scholastic_offences.pdf

All required papers may be subject to submission for textual similarity review to the commercial plagiarism-detection software under license to the University for the detection of plagiarism. All papers submitted for such checking will be included as source documents in the reference database for the purpose of detecting plagiarism of papers subsequently submitted to the system. Use of the service is subject to the licensing agreement, currently between Western University and Turnitin.com (<http://www.turnitin.com>).

C. Health/Wellness Services

Course materials cannot be sold/shared/uploaded. Sessions cannot be recorded/shared.

Students who are in emotional/mental distress should refer to Mental Health Support at <https://www.uwo.ca/health/psych/index.html> for a complete list of options about how to obtain help.

D. Accessible Education (AE)

Western is committed to achieving barrier-free accessibility for all its members, including graduate students. As part of this commitment, Western provides a variety of services devoted to promoting, advocating, and accommodating persons with disabilities in their respective graduate program. Course Outlines Graduate students with disabilities (for example, chronic illnesses, mental health conditions, mobility impairments) are strongly encouraged to register with Accessible Education (AE), a confidential service designed to support graduate and undergraduate students through their academic program. With the appropriate documentation, the student will work with both AE and their graduate programs (normally their Graduate Chair and/or Course instructor) to ensure that appropriate academic accommodations to program requirements are arranged. These accommodations may include individual counselling, alternative formatted literature, accessible campus transportation, learning strategy instruction, writing exams and assistive technology instruction.

E. Statement on Gender-Based and Sexual Violence

Western is committed to reducing incidents of gender-based and sexual violence (GBSV) and providing compassionate support to anyone who is going through or has gone through these traumatic events. If you are experiencing or have experienced GBSV (either recently or in the past), you will find information about support services for survivors, including emergency contacts at the following website: https://www.uwo.ca/health/student_support/survivor_support/get-help.html

To connect with a case manager or set up an appointment, please contact support@uwo.ca

F. Statement on the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI)

The University does not currently have a policy on the use of AI text generators, such as ChatGPT, by our students in coursework. Therefore, it is up to the discretion of instructors to decide how best to coach their students on the use of this technology.

In this course, we will embrace the responsible use of AI platforms **for some tasks** to help students automate their workflow and enhance their learning outputs. Your instructors will guide you throughout the course on how to use these technologies appropriately. You will also be required to document and acknowledge if and how you use these tools. Your course instructors will also be transparent with any AI use in this course and will commit to not using tools for grading and feedback.

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